

Q&A: 28 April 2026



AI HACKATHON 2026

Global Hackathon Using AI for Digital Trade Regulatory Analysis

📅 April - October 2026



And World Trade Organization (WTO)

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Building a smart tool for digital trade regulations:

Extract and find updated legal evidence:

- Non-standard government portals, anti-bot barriers, JS rendering
- Unstructured formats: scanned PDFs, images, inconsistent layouts

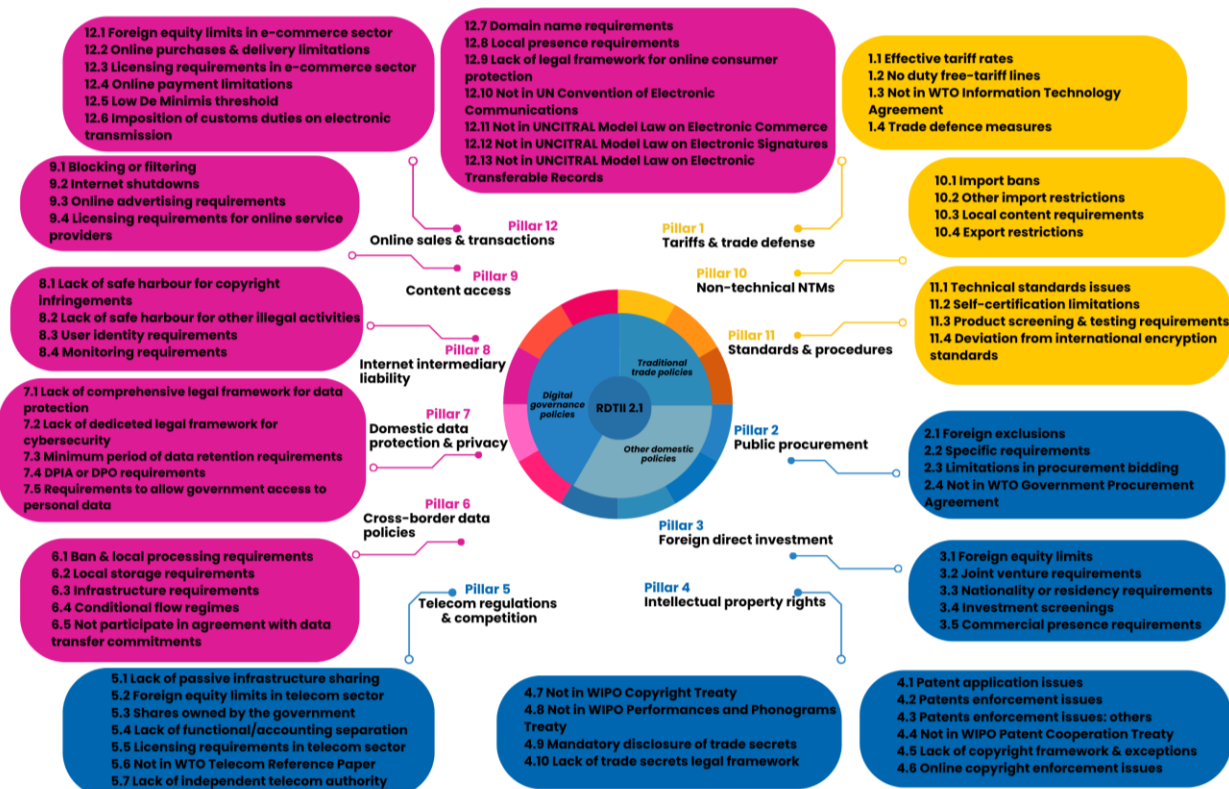
Mapping the collected legal text into a predefined framework:

- Understand semantic triggers (e.g., conditional transfer, prior authorization)
- Provide exact sentence or paragraph as evidence
- Provide precise citations
- Make outputs usable for analysts, policymakers



What is the Competition About?

RDTII: 12 Pillars (50+ indicators)



- The Regional Digital Trade Integration Index (RDTII) provides a framework for understanding digital trade-related regulatory environments.
- **12 pillars, 50+ indicators.**
- Data collection was a manual and intensive process

What is the competition framework?

Explore the Regional Digital Trade Integration Index (RDTII) Guide 2.1:



What is the Expected Workflow?

- The automated tools must handle of the work, such as [searching, translating, and pre-categorizing legal texts](#), while the policy leads must verify and ensure the accuracy of the results provided by the tool.
- This hybrid approach reduces processing time from months to weeks and enables near real-time, evidence-based policy insights.

1

Search & Shortlist

1. The output provides the *title*, *last update*, *URL* and *scope* of application (horizontal vs sectoral) of the relevant law

Issues:

- Non-standard government portals, anti-bot barriers, JS rendering
- Unstructured formats: scanned PDFs, images, inconsistent layouts
- Hallucinations when commercial LLM models are used

2

Retrieve

1. identifies *relevant provisions* and *describes* their impact
2. The proposed AI tool must analyze and map **AT LEAST** two RDTII Pillars:
 - *Cross-border data flows* (Pillar 6) and
 - *Domestic data protection* (Pillar 7)

3

Review

Review and ensure accuracy

1. The tool provides list and details of relevant regulations: the **title**, **last update**, and **scope** of application (horizontal vs sectoral) of the relevant law, identifies **relevant provisions** and **describes** their impact
2. For each law, a **valid URL** is a must for traceability
3. The proposed AI tool must analyze and map AT LEAST two RDTII Pillars:
 - **Cross-border data flows** (Pillar 6) and
 - **Domestic data protection** (Pillar 7)(Extra points will be awarded to scalable tools)

**Mandatory
Outputs**

Useful links

KMITL Event Page: [digitaltradehack2026 - ENGINEER](#)

ESCAP Event Page: [Global Hackathon on Using AI for Digital Trade Regulatory Analysis | ESCAP](#)

Registration Link: [Global Hackathon Using AI for Digital Trade Regulatory Analysis – Application Form](#)

Regional Digital Trade Integration Index (RDTII) is the framework for the competition:

RDTII Framework: [Structure of Analysis | ESCAP](#)

RDTII Guide: [Regional Digital Trade Integration Index \(RDTII\) 2.1 : a guide | ESCAP](#)

Still have a question?
Send us a message by email!

Contact: ESCAP | escap-digitaltrade-hackathon@un.org ;
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